

Encryptions used

Internet data is sent in the form of encrypted packets in a secure wireless connection. Encryption is done with the network security keys. Access to a key virtually allows access to the particular wireless internet network connection.

There are majorly two types of encryptions used.

WEP (Wired Equivalent Privacy)

This is the most basic form of encryption and hence is the easiest to crack. This is not recommended as it is vulnerable and can be cracked relatively easily. There are uncountable attacks, uncountable vulnerabilities, uncountable research papers listing the issues, uncountable tools to get the passwords. It isn't hard to learn how to hack these. Despite its shortcomings, many people still stick to this encryption.



WPA (Wi-Fi Protected Access)

This form of encryption is much more secure than WEP. The only efficient way of cracking a password of such a network is to use a wordlist with the common passwords stored in them. Theoretically, it's a way to get in, and practically this takes forever. Brute force and dictionary attacks are the basic methods to get in the network. A variation of the WPA, WPA-2 is the most secure encryption till now. It is virtually uncrackable with a strong password. The only possibility of cracking it is guessing the paraphrase in case of a weak password, for example, if the default WPA PIN is still enabled in the router.